

Ella De Falco

PhD Researcher / Linguistics

linkedin.com/elladefalco
eldefalco.github.io
(315) 484 6421
elladefalco@icloud.com

SKILLS

Tools and Programming	Python, Java, Git, R, RStudio
Research Areas	Speech Production, Speech Perception, Automatic Speech Recognition, Emotion Recognition
Quantitative Research	Experiment design, Hypothesis Testing, Data Analysis and Visualization, Statistical Modeling
Qualitative Research	Cluster Analysis, Interviews, Pile Sort

EXPERIENCE

Laboratory Assistant <i>University of Washington Linguistics</i>	August 2025 — Present Seattle, WA
- Administer computing systems, databases, and experimental equipment for 4 research laboratories. - Conduct statistical modeling in Python, R, and MATLAB across preexisting linguistic datasets. - Implement experimental designs in Python, generate data visualizations, and communicate findings to faculty and research teams.	
Research Assistant – Experiment Design (Eye-tracking) <i>University of Washington Medical Center</i>	September 2023 — December 2024 Seattle, WA
Designed and implemented behavioral eye-tracking experiment using Eyelink ExperimentBuilder to evaluate the impact of caption quality on user perception under degraded audio conditions.	
Research Assistant – Data Analysis and Project Management <i>University of Washington Linguistics</i>	January 2023 — June 2023 Seattle, WA
<i>Project 1:</i> Analyzed 12 participant datasets containing nasal airflow and acoustic data. Applied statistical modeling to quantify relationships between oral/nasal airflow and speech production, contributing to a novel measurement framework. <i>Project 2:</i> Managed recruitment and execution of an experiment on speech perception of English consonants, coordinating a 5-member research team.	

PROJECTS

Cross-Corpus Speech Emotion Recognition	January 2025 — Present
- Analyze 6 different speech emotion corpora to identify cross-linguistic acoustic patterns in speech production. - Compare human and algorithmic classification accuracy to detect sources of misclassification.	
Survey and Acoustic Analysis of Emotional Infant-Directed Speech	June 2024 — Present
- Designed, implemented, and executed emotion survey with 75 parents during 15 minute parent-child play sessions in a soundproof laboratory booth. - Develop models linking acoustic features from parents' speech during play to emotional states named in the survey.	
Interviews, Pile Sort and Cluster Analysis of Emotion Terms in Panāra	January 2024 — Present
- Designed and implemented audiovisual touchscreen pile sorting tool, used by 32 non-literate participants to sort 35 Panāra language emotion terms. - Using pile sort and interview results, assessed attitudes toward emotion. Applied clustering and similarity metrics to analyze semantic relationships.	

EDUCATION

PhD in Linguistics , <i>University of Washington</i>	expected June 2027
MS in Computational Linguistics , <i>University of Washington</i>	expected December 2025
MA in Linguistics , <i>University of Hawaii at Mānoa</i>	July 2022
Fulbright Scholarship , <i>Gent, Belgium</i>	Sep 2018 - June 2019
BA in Linguistics , <i>University of Rochester</i>	June 2018

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS, PUBLICATIONS, AND AWARDS

Linguistics Society at UW President	2024 — 2025
Arienne Dwyer Language Documentation Award Recipient	2024 — 2025
Excellence in Linguistic Research Award Recipient	2024 — 2025
Conference on Laboratory Phonology 19, <i>Oral Presentation - First Author</i>	Summer 2024
Sound Systems of Latin America 4, <i>Oral Presentation</i>	Fall 2024
Jacobs Research Funds Grant Recipient	2023 — 2025
Leveraging supplementary text data to kick-start automatic speech recognition system development with limited transcriptions, <i>ComputEl Proceedings Paper</i>	Spring 2023